

DOCUMENT 35

SPONSORSHIP ASK MENU & PARTNERSHIP OPPORTUNITY GUIDE

Internal Guide for Student Fellow Outreach & Leadership Sponsorship Conversations

Purpose: Give the outreach team a consistent menu of partnership pathways so every interested organization receives an ask that matches its capacity, mission and resources. This is an **internal asking guide**; it is not a public rate card and does not automatically guarantee benefits, naming rights, exclusivity, media exposure or access to participants.

THE CORE PRINCIPLE

Do not ask every organization for the same thing. Match the ask to the prospect. A technology company may be strongest for devices and STEM. An airline may be strongest for travel. A media company may provide donated exposure. A local law firm may be a cash sponsor. A university may provide scholarships, mentors or experiences.

1. CASH SPONSORSHIP ASK LADDER

Ask	Internal Level	Best Fit	Potential Use
\$5,000	COMMUNITY SPONSOR	Local businesses, professional firms, dealerships, healthcare groups, regional companies	Support student/community programming, awards or outreach.
\$10,000	SUPPORTING PARTNER	Regional brands, banks, employers, retailers, service companies	Support a defined program component, student awards, outreach or event needs.
\$25,000	IMPACT PARTNER	Larger corporations, foundations, banks, technology, healthcare and consumer brands	Meaningful support for student awards, scholarships, programming or community activation.
\$50,000	LEADERSHIP PARTNER	Major corporations, national brands, financial institutions, technology companies	Major program support, scholarship pool, statewide activation or defined strategic initiative.
\$100,000+	MAJOR / PRESENTING DISCUSSION	Large corporations, foundations or strategic institutions with strong alignment	Leadership-led discussion for transformational program support; benefits and terms negotiated separately.

Important: These levels guide the conversation. Leadership determines the final proposal, recognition, deliverables, restrictions and agreement. Fellows should never negotiate special benefits independently.

2. WHAT CAN A SPONSOR SUPPORT?

Opportunity	Examples of Support
Student Scholarships & Awards	Cash support toward approved student scholarships, cash awards or prizes.
School Awards	Support approved school awards, educational resources or school participation initiatives.
Teacher Recognition	Support approved teacher prizes, professional experiences or recognition.
Student Programming	Workshops, educational materials, entrepreneurship/STEM/community problem-solving programming.
Community Outreach	Student recruitment, family outreach, printed materials, community activations and awareness.
Awards / Final Event	Venue, production, food, staging, signage, photography, videography and event operations.
Technology	Laptops, tablets, software, devices, connectivity, AI/STEM resources or approved technology experiences.
Travel & Experiences	Airfare, hotel stays, resort packages, attraction tickets, museum/sports experiences or transportation.
Media & Awareness	Billboards, radio, TV, print, digital advertising, social amplification, PSAs or media inventory.
Career Exposure	Employee mentors, speakers, workplace tours, approved internships for eligible participants or career education.

3. NO CASH BUDGET? 15 OTHER WAYS TO SUPPORT

Alternative	How It Can Help
1. Laptops / Tablets / Devices	Technology prizes or approved program equipment.
2. Airfare / Travel Certificates	Travel support for approved winners, teachers or program experiences.
3. Hotel / Resort Stays	Teacher prize or approved winner/family experiences.
4. Attraction / Sports / Museum Tickets	Student and family experiences, group outings or prizes.
5. Gift Cards / Products	Retail, food, school supplies, clothing, electronics or other approved prizes.
6. Printing / Signage	Flyers, banners, foam boards, event signage, booklets and program materials.
7. Media Inventory	Billboards, radio spots, digital ads, TV inventory, print placements or PSAs.
8. Venue Space	Awards ceremony, workshops, student showcases, press events or meetings.
9. Food / Catering	Meals, snacks, beverages or event catering.
10. Transportation	Bus, rail, rides, charter or approved transportation support.
11. Professional Services	Legal, accounting, design, marketing, photography, video, translation or event production.
12. Employee Mentors / Speakers	Approved professionals who can educate and inspire students.
13. Career Experiences	Workplace visits, facility tours, demonstrations or approved career-learning opportunities.
14. Software / Educational Access	Learning platforms, design tools, coding, AI, language, tutoring or other approved licenses.
15. Introductions & Distribution	Introduce other funders/partners or distribute the challenge through trusted networks.

4. CATEGORY-SPECIFIC ASK GUIDE

Category	Strongest Ask Paths
Banks / Financial	\$10K-\$100K+; scholarships; financial-literacy speakers; community support.
Technology / AI	\$25K-\$100K+; devices; software; STEM mentors; technology experiences.
Airlines / Travel	Airfare; travel certificates; cash; career exposure; awareness.
Hotels / Resorts	Teacher/winner stay packages; experiences; cash; hospitality careers.
Retail / Consumer Brands	Cash; gift cards; products; student prizes; awareness.
Food / Restaurants	Cash; meals; gift cards; event catering; community activation.
Healthcare / Insurance	Cash; scholarships; career education; community-health resources.
Law / Accounting / Professional Firms	\$5K-\$25K+ local/regional sponsorship; mentors; professional education.
Media / Advertising	Donated media; coverage; creative/PR services; cash sponsorship.
Sports / Entertainment	Tickets; experiences; awareness; athlete/executive engagement where approved; cash.
Universities / Trade Schools	Scholarships; campus experiences; mentors; student distribution; career education.
Engineering / Manufacturing	Cash; STEM mentors; tours; demonstrations; technology.
Amusement / Attractions	Tickets; family passes; experiences; teacher prizes; cash.
Transportation / Automotive	Cash; transportation; career exposure; vehicle/technology demonstrations where appropriate.
Local Businesses	\$1K-\$10K+ when appropriate; gift cards; products; community awareness; services.

5. PRIMARY ASK + SECONDARY ASK METHOD

Before every serious sponsor conversation, write down **one primary ask and one secondary ask**. Do not present ten unrelated requests at once.

Example — Technology company: Primary: \$50,000 support for student technology/innovation programming. Secondary: laptops, software access and employee STEM mentors.

Example — Airline: Primary: airfare support for approved program travel. Secondary: cash sponsorship and aviation-career experiences.

Example — Local law firm: Primary: \$5,000-\$10,000 community sponsorship. Secondary: approved career speaker or professional-services support.

Example — Billboard company: Primary: donated out-of-home advertising inventory. Secondary: cash sponsorship or creative/production assistance.

6. RECOGNITION & BENEFITS - WHAT CAN BE DISCUSSED

Potential recognition may include approved logo placement, website acknowledgment, event signage, social-media acknowledgment, program materials, sponsor recognition at approved events or other benefits leadership has authorized. The exact package should reflect the contribution and program needs.

Never automatically promise: naming rights, presenting rights, exclusivity, guaranteed media coverage, guaranteed impressions, guaranteed attendance, celebrity access, participant/student data, direct marketing to minors, judge influence, winner-selection influence, special access to students, category ownership, tax treatment or any benefit not formally approved.

7. IN-KIND VALUATION RULE

Record cash and in-kind support separately. For in-kind contributions, request documentation or use a reasonable standard/retail value that leadership can verify. Do not inflate value for publicity. A donation of 200 tickets with a documented standard value of \$50 each may be tracked internally as approximately \$10,000 of in-kind value, subject to leadership/accounting review.

8. WHEN TO CUSTOMIZE THE PROPOSAL

Customize after discovery when the organization has shown real interest. Tailor the proposal to its priorities, requested contribution, geography, audience and desired approved recognition. Do not create a new sponsorship package for every cold prospect before they engage.

9. INTERNAL APPROVAL CHECKLIST BEFORE A FORMAL OFFER

- Contribution amount or in-kind item is clearly defined.
- Program use is feasible and appropriate.
- Recognition/benefits are approved and deliverable.
- No exclusivity or naming rights have been implied without approval.
- No student/participant data access is promised.
- Any travel, venue, food, technology or experience restrictions are understood.
- Tax, legal, insurance and compliance questions are escalated appropriately.
- Contribution valuation is not exaggerated.
- Leadership owner and next action are recorded in the CRM.
- Public announcement waits until confirmation and approved language/logo use.

10. SIMPLE DECISION TREE

They have budget? → Select the appropriate cash ask. **No budget?** → Move to in-kind, awareness, expertise or distribution. **They want something custom?** → Record the request and leadership reviews it. **They are interested but timing is wrong?** → Record the next budget cycle and move to Nurture. **They want to commit?** → Move into the Document 34 closing/documentation process.

11. THE GOAL IS VALUE ALIGNMENT

The best partnership is not necessarily the largest check. A company that provides \$10,000 plus 100 laptops, or a media company that provides substantial donated exposure, or a parent network that reaches thousands of eligible families may create extraordinary program value. Measure cash, in-kind, reach, experiences and strategic value separately.

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